PRELUDE XVIII

WITH a few extra notes in the second bar and a fourth part in the final close, this Prelude is a three-part Invention developing the figures of its first bar, direct and by inversion (see bars 10, 15-17, 25-26 episodically, and 28) in a close-knit texture.

The *tempo* is a flowing *Andante cantabile*, and the touch *legato* throughout, with particular care to let the suspended discords sing. Note the low bass in bars 17-18 as indicating full tone, and mark the expressive downward steps of bar 24. Ask a good violinist to show what the right hand of that bar would mean in double stops with an expressive swell and the *louré* stroke  , in which the bow repeats the notes without changing its direction or leaving the strings.

The slurs in bar 7 are authentic.

FUGUE XVIII

THE remarkable Episode 1, (bars 8-9) with its apparently homophonic chords, the two-bar rhythm unbroken in its regularity until half-way through the Fugue, and the full closes at every phrase (modified only by the suspensions caused by the second Countersubject), have led some Bach scholars to suppose that this is an early work, or, at all events, a return to an archaic style. This is about as true as it is of the Menuet in Beethoven's Eighth Symphony. The fact that such forms have existed in an older or more primitive art is no reason why the composer should not explore their possibilities in a more subtle style. Bach, in the *Sicut locutus est* of his *Magnificat*, writes a far more primitive and square-cut little Fugue in order to make a surprisingly short *Gloria* give a strong momentary impression of spaciousness; and nobody has ever dreamt of taking his *Magnificat* for an early work.

With all its apparent simplicity and squareness, this Fugue is one of the profoundest in the whole Forty-eight. Of its two very important Countersubjects the first, together with the last figure of the Subject, gives rise to Episodes 1, 2, and 5, and to the latter part of Episode 4.

The Second Countersubject, consisting of five longer notes and a suspension, supports all the harmony, bridges over most of the cadences, and requires a singing tone swelling out so that the suspended minim may last. This is extremely important for Episode 2 (bars 13-14) and for the new material of Episodes 3 and 4 (bars 21-23, etc.).

The Subject forms a touchstone for the player's feeling for Bach's language. It is unlikely that any singer would naturally misread its second figure; if the pianist feels the slightest temptation to slur it iambically across the beats, he may take warning that he has much to unlearn before he can interpret Bach. The simplest melodious detached accentuation is all that is possible with those repeated notes. The rest of the theme should be *legato*, with no break between the G♯ and C×.

The detached chords are a notable exception to the rule that Bach uses them chiefly in climaxes. Here the pianist's touch should be modelled on the softest registers of the swell or choir organ.

The *tempo* is a deliberate *Andante*, and the touch quiet and sensitive throughout, any *forte* being quite out of the question.

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